

# IMAGINATION LIBRARY OF SAN ANTONIO

Fiscal Report  
September 2024–May 2026





# Contents

|          |                                                            |          |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Introduction</b>                                        | <b>3</b> |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Financial Report</b>                                    | <b>6</b> |
| 2.1      | Financial Overview (September 2024–May 2026) . . . . .     | 7        |
| 2.1.1    | Executive Summary . . . . .                                | 7        |
| 2.1.2    | Income . . . . .                                           | 7        |
| 2.1.3    | Expenses . . . . .                                         | 7        |
| 2.1.4    | Cash Flow and Reserves . . . . .                           | 8        |
| 2.1.5    | Outlook . . . . .                                          | 8        |
| 2.2      | Budget and Forward Plan . . . . .                          | 9        |
| 2.2.1    | Annual Operating Budget (August 2025 – July 2026) . . . .  | 9        |
| 2.2.1.1  | Operational and Marketing Costs . . . . .                  | 9        |
| 2.2.2    | Reserve Projection Scenarios (through December 2029) . . . | 9        |
| 2.2.3    | Governance and Compliance . . . . .                        | 10       |
| 2.2.4    | Figures . . . . .                                          | 10       |



ILSA

# Chapter 1

## Introduction



## A Message from Our Board

Dear Friends, Supporters, and Community Partners,

We are proud to present the inaugural annual fiscal report for the Imagination Library of San Antonio (ILSA). As a newly established 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization, 2024 marked a pivotal year in our journey to transform early childhood literacy in our beloved city.

### Our Foundation

In 2024, ILSA officially became a Local Program Partner of Dolly Parton's Imagination Library, joining a global network of communities committed to putting books in the hands of children from birth to age five. This milestone represents more than an organizational achievement—it signifies our community's collective commitment to ensuring that every child in San Antonio has access to the fundamental building blocks of learning and imagination.

### Our Mission in Action

At ILSA, we believe that books are the building blocks of a brighter future. Our mission is clear and unwavering: to ensure that all young children in San Antonio may participate in our major local programming through enrollment in Dolly Parton's Imagination Library. By providing free, high-quality books to children from birth to age 5, we support early childhood education and inspire a lifelong love of reading.

### Our Commitment

Guided by our small but dedicated board of community-minded individuals, we are driven by three fundamental goals:

- **Universal Enrollment:** Achieving equitable access to books by enrolling all eligible children in every zip code throughout San Antonio, Texas
- **Community Investment:** Increasing donations and sponsorships to launch, grow, and sustain this vital program for all of San Antonio's children
- **Educational Impact:** Enhancing local kindergarten readiness by investing in critical foundational reading skills



## Looking Forward

This report details our financial stewardship, operational achievements, and the generous support from donors and sponsors who share our vision. Every dollar invested in ILSA represents an investment in San Antonio's future—one book, one child, one brighter tomorrow at a time. We invite you to explore the pages that follow to see how your support has translated into tangible impact for our community's youngest learners. Together, we are building not just literacy, but hope, opportunity, and brighter futures for all.

With gratitude, **The Board of Directors** Imagination Library of San Antonio

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*For questions about this report or our programs, please contact us at:  
[admin@imaginationlibrarysa.org](mailto:admin@imaginationlibrarysa.org)*

Learn more about Dolly Parton's Imagination Library: [imaginationlibrary.com/usa](http://imaginationlibrary.com/usa)



ILSA

## Chapter 2

# Financial Report



## 2.1 Financial Overview (September 2024–May 2026)

### 2.1.1 Executive Summary

The Imagination Library of San Antonio (ILSA) is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit and Local Program Partner of Dolly Parton’s Imagination Library, mailing free books each month to children from birth to age five in San Antonio. This report summarizes financial activity over the 21 months of September 2024–May 2026.

During this period ILSA received \$196,543 in total income against \$12,664 in expenses. Accumulated reserves stood at \$183,879 at the close of the period.

- **Recurring giving** (online donations and subscriptions via PayPal and Bonterra): \$8,495 (4.3% of income), averaging \$405 per month.
- **Grants and major gifts** (deposited at the bank): \$188,047 (95.7% of income) across 11 deposits; the largest was \$110,000 in December 2025.
- **Program cost** (monthly payments to the Dollywood Foundation for book distribution): \$12,163.

Recurring giving did not fully cover this cost, leaving an operating deficit of \$3,668 that was funded from grants and accumulated reserves. This is the central dynamic of ILSA’s finances: day-to-day donations do not yet cover the cost of the book program, so the organization relies on periodic grants and major gifts to build and sustain reserves.

### 2.1.2 Income

| Income Source                        | 2024            | 2025             | 2026            | Total            |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|-----------------|------------------|
| Recurring giving (PayPal + Bonterra) | \$1,502         | \$5,878          | \$1,116         | \$8,495          |
| Grants & major gifts (bank deposits) | \$25,200        | \$143,168        | \$19,679        | \$188,047        |
| <b>Total income</b>                  | <b>\$26,702</b> | <b>\$149,046</b> | <b>\$20,795</b> | <b>\$196,543</b> |

Table 2.1: Income by source and calendar year (2024 and 2026 are partial; data spans September 2024–May 2026).

Recurring giving is the predictable, forecastable stream. Grants and major gifts are episodic by nature and are reported as discrete events rather than a trend.

### 2.1.3 Expenses

The program cost grows as enrollment increases, since ILSA pays per child served. It is the organization’s dominant and steadily rising expense.



| Expense Category              | 2024       | 2025           | 2026           | Total           |
|-------------------------------|------------|----------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Program – Imagination Library | \$0        | \$8,144        | \$4,019        | \$12,163        |
| Other (fees, chargebacks)     | \$1        | \$0            | \$500          | \$501           |
| <b>Total expenses</b>         | <b>\$1</b> | <b>\$8,144</b> | <b>\$4,519</b> | <b>\$12,664</b> |

Table 2.2: Operating expenses by calendar year. The program cost reflects 12 payments to the Dollywood Foundation over September 2024–May 2026.

### 2.1.4 Cash Flow and Reserves

| Cash Flow Component     | 2024            | 2025             | 2026             | Full Period      |
|-------------------------|-----------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
| Opening reserves        | \$0             | \$26,700         | \$167,603        | \$0              |
| Total income            | \$26,702        | \$149,046        | \$20,795         | \$196,543        |
| Total expenses          | (\$1)           | (\$8,144)        | (\$4,519)        | (\$12,664)       |
| <b>Net change</b>       | <b>\$26,700</b> | <b>\$140,902</b> | <b>\$16,276</b>  | <b>\$183,879</b> |
| <b>Closing reserves</b> | <b>\$26,700</b> | <b>\$167,603</b> | <b>\$183,879</b> | <b>\$183,879</b> |

Table 2.3: Consolidated cash flow by calendar year. Reserves are inception-to-date, so each year's opening equals the prior year's closing. Internal PayPal–bank transfers are netted out so donations are counted once.

Closing reserves of \$183,879 are healthy, but it should be understood that the bulk of these reserves originates from one-time grants and major gifts rather than from recurring operations.

### 2.1.5 Outlook

Projections extend the period's linear trend of recurring giving and program cost forward, holding grants at zero (new grants are not assumed). On that basis:

- Recurring-giving trend: -\$9 per month.
- Program-cost trend: \$61 per month.
- Projected reserves: \$167,908 by May 2027 and \$141,847 by May 2028.

Because grants are episodic and excluded from the projection, this is a deliberately conservative view: a single new grant or major gift materially improves the outlook. The practical implication is that sustaining and growing *recurring* giving is the key to long-term operating sustainability.





## 2.2 Budget and Forward Plan

### 2.2.1 Annual Operating Budget (August 2025 – July 2026)

The board adopted the following enrollment and program-cost budget for the fiscal year. Actual program cost is drawn from recorded Dollywood (Imagination Library) payments; months without a recorded payment are shown as “—”.

| Month        | Budget Kids | Actual Kids | Budget Inv.     | Actual Inv.     | Variance |
|--------------|-------------|-------------|-----------------|-----------------|----------|
| Aug          | 370         | 241         | \$900           | \$783           | \$117    |
| Sep          | 425         | 259         | \$1,000         | \$904           | \$96     |
| Oct          | 490         | 295         | \$1,200         | \$1,011         | \$189    |
| Nov          | 560         | 351         | \$1,350         | \$1,712         | -\$362   |
| Dec          | 650         | 385         | \$1,580         | \$1,767         | -\$187   |
| Jan          | 750         | 653         | \$1,800         | \$1,805         | -\$5     |
| Feb          | 850         | 720         | \$2,100         | —               | —        |
| Mar          | 980         | 728         | \$2,400         | \$2,214         | \$186    |
| Apr          | 1,120       | 905         | \$2,750         | —               | —        |
| May          | 1,300       | 957         | \$3,200         | —               | —        |
| Jun          | 1,500       | 1,000       | \$3,650         | —               | —        |
| Jul          | 1,700       | —           | \$4,200         | —               | —        |
| <b>Total</b> | —           | —           | <b>\$26,130</b> | <b>\$10,196</b> |          |

Table 2.4: Monthly enrollment and program-cost budget vs. actual, August 2025 – July 2026.

#### 2.2.1.1 Operational and Marketing Costs

| Item     | Budgeted | Frequency | Notes |
|----------|----------|-----------|-------|
| Mail Box | \$350    | yearly    |       |

Table 2.5: Budgeted operational and marketing costs.

### 2.2.2 Reserve Projection Scenarios (through December 2029)

Reserves are projected from the linear trend of recurring giving and program cost on past data (the baseline shown in the income-and-expense projection). The optimistic and pessimistic scenarios vary that baseline net cash flow by  $\pm 15\%$  per year, widening the range over time. No new grants are assumed, so all three are conservative views.

Under the baseline, reserves decline from \$183,879 today to \$80,193 by December 2029 (\$41,557 pessimistic, \$110,478 optimistic). The decline is gradual because



| Year-end | Pessimistic ( $-15\%/yr$ ) | Baseline  | Optimistic ( $+15\%/yr$ ) |
|----------|----------------------------|-----------|---------------------------|
| Dec 2026 | \$175,377                  | \$175,789 | \$176,238                 |
| Dec 2027 | \$149,641                  | \$153,932 | \$158,126                 |
| Dec 2028 | \$106,454                  | \$121,984 | \$135,580                 |
| Dec 2029 | \$41,557                   | \$80,193  | \$110,478                 |

Table 2.6: Projected reserves at each year-end under the baseline and  $\pm 15\%/yr$  scenarios.

recurring giving nearly offsets the current program cost; the gap widens only as the program grows. A single new grant or major gift – excluded here by design – would materially extend the runway.

### 2.2.3 Governance and Compliance

ILSA maintains its IRS 501(c)(3) tax-exempt status, complies with Texas nonprofit corporation requirements, and operates under the partnership guidelines of Dolly Parton’s Imagination Library. Financial activity is reviewed by the board, with segregation of duties across financial processes.

### 2.2.4 Figures

The figures that follow summarize the period. “Monthly Income and Expense Analysis” separates recurring operating activity (top) from episodic grants and major gifts (bottom), since the latter are large enough to obscure the former on a single scale. “Accumulated Reserves” traces the consolidated cash position over time, with grant events annotated. “Income and Expense Projections” extends the recurring-giving and program-cost trends forward, and “Projected Reserves” carries that same baseline trend to December 2029 with an optimistic/pessimistic band of  $\pm 15\%$  per year. The final map, “San Antonio Areas Served by ILSA,” gives geographic context to the program’s reach.

*Financial figures generated from ledger data by `treasurer.py`; see `ILSA-commands.tex`.*



Figure 2.2-1: Monthly Income and Expense Analysis

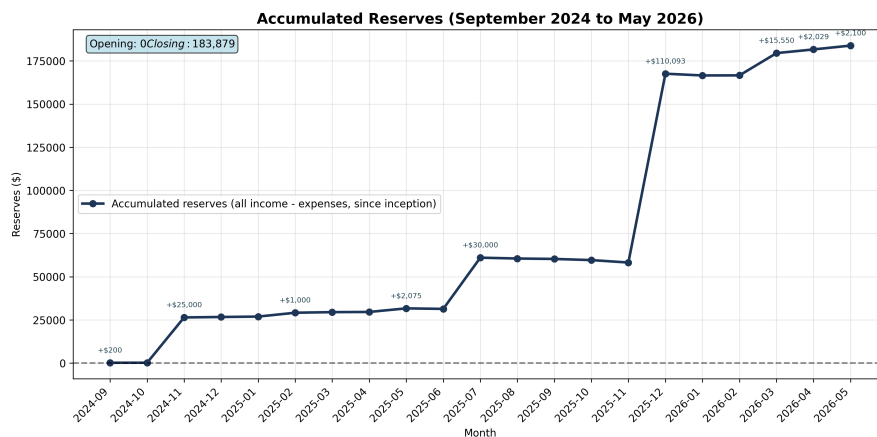


Figure 2.2-2: Accumulated Reserves

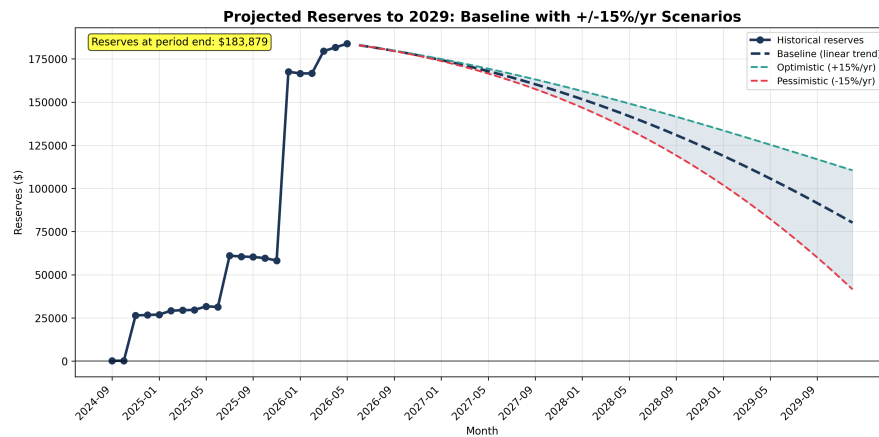


Figure 2.2-3: Projected Reserves to December 2029: Baseline (linear trend) with  $\pm 15\%/yr$  Optimistic and Pessimistic Scenarios

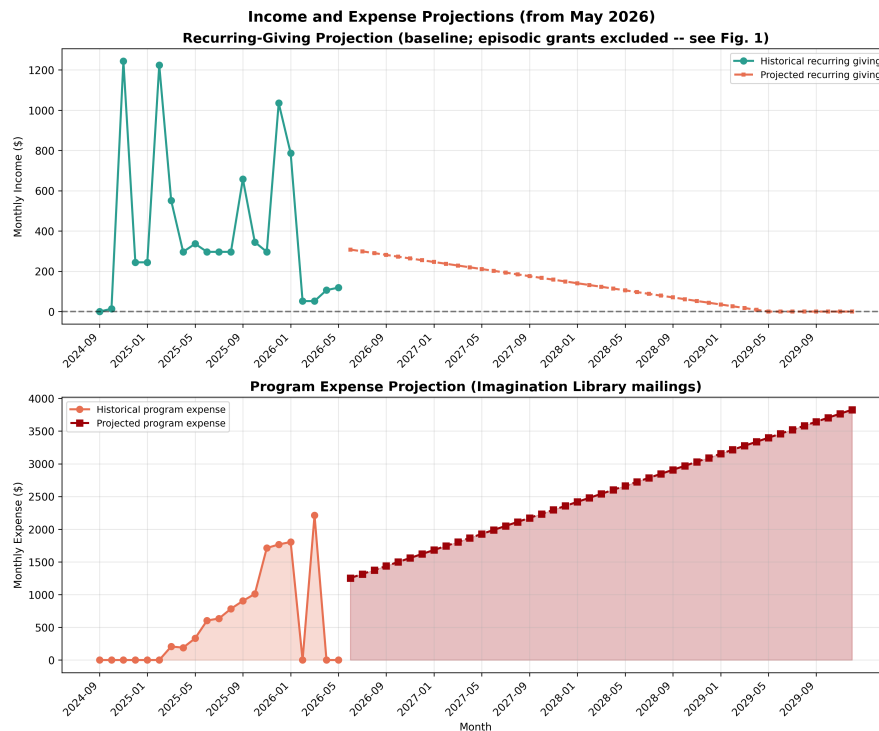


Figure 2.2-4: Income and Expense Projections

